DEVELOPMENT PLAN & FEATURE ROADMAP

AI CFO for Hotels

Features • Integrations • Revenue Model • Partner Marketplace • Sprint Plan

YC Summer 2026 — Pre-Application Sprint

TEAM ROLES

Svar	Engineering Lead — Architecture, backend, frontend, AI features, implementation
Parth	Engineering — Frontend overhaul, UI/UX, onboarding flow (joining soon)
Arjun	Business — Industry research, contact spreadsheet, outreach, partner sourcing
Aarush	Brand & Ops — Branding, logo, YC video/application, outreach support

DEADLINE: 3–5 paying clients + YC application in 2 weeks

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1. Revenue Model (Three Streams)

We have three distinct revenue sources. This makes the business significantly more attractive to YC because it's not just SaaS — it's SaaS + marketplace + data.

Stream 1: SaaS Subscription (Core Platform)

Tier	Target	Price	Includes
Starter	1–2 properties	$299/mo	Dashboard, AI summary, anomaly alerts, 1 PMS integration
Growth	3–15 properties	$799/mo/property	+ Benchmarking, forecasting, multi-PMS, partner recommendations
Enterprise	15+ properties	Custom ($2K+/mo)	+ White-glove, SLA, custom integrations, dedicated support

Hotels pay a monthly fee for access to the AI CFO dashboard, AI summaries, anomaly alerts, forecasting, and all integrations.

Stream 2: AI Cost Cutter Partner Marketplace (Affiliate Revenue)

This is the big differentiator. When our AI identifies a cost that's above market rate, it doesn't just flag it — it recommends a specific cheaper alternative from our vetted partner network. We take a referral fee or revenue share from every switch.

How It Works

- AI analyzes the hotel's actual spending across vendors (linen suppliers, cleaning products, toiletries, F&B distributors, insurance, energy, credit card processing, OTA commissions, software subscriptions, maintenance contractors)
- Platform compares their costs to market benchmarks AND to negotiated rates we've secured from partner vendors
- AI surfaces a recommendation: "You're paying $4.20/room for toiletries. Our partner EcoStay offers the same quality at $2.85/room. Switch and save $8,100/year."
- Hotel clicks "Switch" or "Get Quote" — we connect them directly to the partner vendor
- We earn a referral fee (flat per switch) or ongoing revenue share (5–15% of contract value) from the partner

Revenue Model for Partners

Partner Type	Example Partners	Our Cut	Est. Revenue/Hotel/Year
Linen & Laundry	CleanCloud, CORT, local suppliers	10–15% of first-year contract	$500–$2,000
Toiletries & Amenities	EcoStay, Gilchrist & Soames, bulk suppliers	8–12% rev share	$300–$1,500
Cleaning & Chemicals	Ecolab, Diversey, local distributors	10% rev share	$400–$1,200

F&B Distribution	Sysco, US Foods, local suppliers	5–8% on redirected spend	$1,000–$5,000
Energy / Utilities	Constellation, Arcadia, Verdant EMS	$200–$500 flat referral	$200–$500
Insurance	Zurich, Tokio Marine, Petra Risk	$500–$1,500 flat referral	$500–$1,500
Credit Card Processing	Stax, Square, Stripe	Rev share on processing volume	$1,000–$3,000
Software & SaaS Tools	PMS, CRM, revenue mgmt tools	Affiliate referral fee	$200–$1,000
Maintenance & HVAC	Local contractors, Turno, Breezeway	10% referral on first job	$300–$800

Potential affiliate/partner revenue per hotel: $4,000–$16,000/year. At 100 hotels, that's $400K–$1.6M/year in partner revenue alone — on top of SaaS subscriptions.

Why Hotels Trust This

- We're not just saying "spend less" — we're showing exactly how much they're overpaying with real data from their own books
- Recommendations are backed by AI analysis of their actual invoices and spending patterns, not generic ads
- Partners are vetted and reviewed by other hotels on the platform (network effect)
- Hotels save money, we make money, partners get customers. Everyone wins.

Stream 3: Data & Insights (Future — Year 2+)

As we onboard hundreds of hotels, we accumulate anonymized benchmarking data that's extremely valuable. Future revenue from selling aggregated industry insights to hotel brands, REITs, consulting firms, and vendors. This is the long-term data moat.

2. Complete Feature Breakdown

Every feature explained in detail. Organized by the five core product domains.

Domain A: AI Financial Summary & Insights

The brain of the platform. Turns raw financial data into plain-English intelligence that any hotel owner or GM can understand without a finance degree.

#	Feature	What It Does	Priority	Owner
A1	**Daily AI Briefing**	Every morning, the AI generates a plain-English summary of yesterday's financial performance. Covers revenue, occupancy, ADR, labor costs, F&B margins, and any anomalies. Example: "Revenue was $12,400 yesterday, down 8% vs. last Tuesday. Your labor cost ratio hit 38% because of 2 unplanned overtime shifts. F&B breakfast underperformed by $340 vs. weekly average." Delivered via dashboard, email, and Slack/WhatsApp.	**MVP**	Svar
A2	**Weekly Financial Report**	AI-generated weekly report summarizing the full week: total revenue, GOP, cost breakdowns by department, week-over-week trends, and top 3 recommended actions.	**V1**	Svar

		Formatted as a clean PDF that owners can forward to investors or partners. Replaces the “thick binder” problem.		
A3	**Ask AI (Chat Interface)**	Natural language chat where owners/GMs can ask questions about their own data. “What was my RevPAR last month?” “Why did F&B costs spike in week 3?” “How does my occupancy compare to last year?” AI answers using their real financial data, not generic advice.	**V1**	Svar
A4	**Variance Explanation Engine**	Whenever a metric changes significantly, AI automatically explains WHY. Not just “GOP dropped 5%” but “GOP dropped 5% because: (1) occupancy fell 3 points due to a cancelled group booking, (2) housekeeping overtime added $1,800, (3) F&B waste was 12% above normal.” Bridges the gap between data and understanding.	**V1**	Svar
A5	**Scenario Modeling**	“What if I raise ADR by $15?” “What if I cut 2 FTEs from housekeeping?” “What if occupancy drops 10% next quarter?” Interactive financial simulations that show projected impact on GOP, cash flow, and margins. Helps owners make decisions with confidence.	**V2**	Eng

Domain B: AI Cost Cutter & Partner Marketplace

The revenue multiplier. Identifies where hotels are overpaying and connects them with cheaper, vetted alternatives. We earn affiliate/referral revenue on every switch.

#	Feature	What It Does	Priority	Owner
B1	**Spend Analysis Dashboard**	Categorizes every dollar the hotel spends: labor, supplies, F&B, energy, insurance, commissions, maintenance, software. Shows spending trends over time, flags categories growing faster than revenue, and highlights the biggest cost-saving opportunities. Visual breakdown: “You spent $42K on supplies last quarter. Here’s where every dollar went.”	**MVP**	Svar
B2	**Cost Anomaly Detection**	Monitors all spending categories in real-time. Flags when any cost spikes unexpectedly: “Your linen costs jumped 22% this month with no occupancy increase. Possible causes: vendor price increase, waste, or theft.” Also catches slow-creep inflation that owners miss: “Your cleaning supply costs have risen 34% over 6 months while occupancy is flat.”	**MVP**	Svar
B3	**Partner Recommendations**	When AI identifies overspending, it recommends a specific alternative from our vetted partner network. “You’re paying $4.20/room for toiletries. Our partner EcoStay offers equivalent quality at $2.85/room. Estimated annual savings: $8,100. [Get Quote] [Compare Details]”. We earn referral fee from the partner on every conversion. Hotels see savings, partners get customers, we get paid.	**V1**	Arjun + Svar
B4	**Vendor Contract Tracker**	Tracks every vendor contract: renewal dates, terms, pricing history. Sends alerts 60 days before renewal: “Your Sysco contract renews in 58 days. You’re paying 14% above market. Here are 3 alternatives.” Prevents the silent NOI leak of auto-renewed contracts that never get rebid.	**V1**	Eng
B5	**Savings Tracker / ROI Dashboard**	Shows the hotel exactly how much money the platform has saved them. Running total: “Since joining, you’ve saved $14,200 by switching vendors, $8,400 by optimizing staffing, and $3,100 by catching cost anomalies early. Total: $25,700.” This is the retention and upsell engine — hard to cancel when you can see the ROI.	**V1**	Parth
B6	**Group Purchasing Power**	As we onboard more hotels, we aggregate purchasing volume to negotiate bulk rates with vendors. “47 hotels on	**V2**	Biz team

		our platform now buy from EcoStay — we've negotiated a 22% discount that individual hotels couldn't get alone." Network effect moat.		

Domain C: Real-Time Monitoring & Alerts

Always-on monitoring that catches problems before they compound. The "early warning system" for hotel finances.

#	Feature	What It Does	Priority	Owner
C1	**Revenue Anomaly Alerts**	Flags when revenue deviates from expected patterns. "Booking.com revenue dropped 31% this week vs. same week last year. Check if your listing is still active and competitive." Catches OTA delisting, rate parity issues, and demand shifts early.	**MVP**	Svar
C2	**Labor Cost Alerts**	Monitors labor cost as % of revenue by department. Alerts when overtime spikes, when staff-to-room ratio exceeds benchmarks, or when scheduling doesn't match occupancy forecasts. "You scheduled 12 housekeeping shifts on Tuesday but only had 34% occupancy. 4 shifts were unnecessary = $680 wasted."	**MVP**	Svar
C3	**F&B Margin Alerts**	Tracks food & beverage costs vs. revenue. Flags when margins drop: "Breakfast food cost hit 42% this week vs. your 30% target. Check for waste or supplier price changes." Helps hotels catch the slow bleed of F&B inefficiency.	**V1**	Eng
C4	**OTA Commission Tracker**	Shows exactly how much each OTA channel costs in commissions. "You paid $8,200 in Booking.com commissions last month. If you shifted 20% of those bookings to direct, you'd save $1,640/month." Visualizes channel profitability, not just channel revenue.	**V1**	Eng
C5	**Notification System**	Multi-channel alert delivery: email, Slack, WhatsApp, SMS, push notification (mobile). Configurable thresholds: owner picks which alerts matter and how urgent. Default: critical alerts (>10% variance) go immediately; weekly digest covers everything else.	**MVP (email) / V1 (Slack, WA)**	Svar

Domain D: Dashboard & Hotel Metrics

The visual command center. Every metric a hotel owner needs, calculated automatically and displayed in real-time.

#	Feature	What It Does	Priority	Owner
D1	**Core Metrics Dashboard**	Auto-calculates and displays: RevPAR (Revenue Per Available Room), ADR (Average Daily Rate), Occupancy Rate, GOPPAR (Gross Operating Profit Per Available Room), TRevPAR (Total Revenue Per Available Room), Labor Cost Ratio, F&B Margin, Channel Mix. All with trend lines, week-over-week and year-over-year comparisons.	**MVP**	Svar → Parth
D2	**Competitive Benchmarking**	Compares the hotel's metrics against local comp set and national averages. "Your RevPAR is $87. Similar hotels in your market average $105. You're leaving $18/room on the table." Uses STR data or our own aggregated data as we scale.	**V1**	Eng
D3	**Cash Flow Forecasting**	90-day forward projection of cash inflows and outflows. Factors in booking pace, seasonality, historical patterns, local events (concerts, conferences, sports), and known expenses. Visual timeline with confidence bands. "You'll	**V1**	Svar

		need $34K in cash reserves by April 15 for insurance + property tax. Current trajectory: $28K. Gap: $6K."		
D4	**Multi-Property Portfolio View**	For operators with 2+ hotels: aggregate dashboard showing all properties side by side. Rank properties by performance. Identify which property is dragging down the portfolio. "Property A is your top performer at 42% GOP margin. Property C is at 28% — here's why."	**V1**	Parth
D5	**Custom Report Builder**	Let owners create custom reports for their investors, banks, or internal meetings. Select metrics, date ranges, and formatting. Export as PDF. Replaces the manual Excel reports most hotels still create.	**V2**	Eng

Domain E: Integrations (Data Sources)

Every integration we need, in priority order. Each one unlocks new features and new data for the AI.

#	Integration	Systems	What Data We Get	Priority
E1	**Property Management System (PMS)**	Mews, Cloudbeds, Little Hotelier, Opera (Oracle), Guesty, RoomRaccoon	Reservations, check-ins, revenue, ADR, occupancy, room types, guest data	**MVP — Start with 1, add more in V1**
E2	**OTA Channels**	Booking.com, Expedia, Airbnb, Hotels.com (via channel manager: SiteMinder, myallocator)	Channel-specific revenue, commission rates, booking volume, cancellation rates	**V1 — Critical for channel profitability analysis**
E3	**Payroll**	Gusto, ADP, Paychex, QuickBooks Payroll. Also CSV upload for manual payroll.	Labor costs by department, overtime hours, headcount, payroll as % of revenue	**V1 — Labor is #1 expense in hotels**
E4	**F&B Point of Sale**	Toast, Square, Lightspeed, Micros (Oracle)	Restaurant/bar revenue, food costs, item-level sales, waste tracking	**V1 — Unlocks F&B margin analysis**
E5	**Accounting Software**	QuickBooks, Xero, Sage, FreshBooks	Full P&L, balance sheet, expense categorization, vendor payments, invoices	**MVP or V1 — Core financial data source**
E6	**Banking / Bank Feeds**	Plaid (connects to any bank), Mercury, Chase, Wells Fargo	Real-time cash balances, transaction categorization, cash flow data	**V1 — Enables real-time cash flow tracking**
E7	**Energy & Utilities**	Verdant EMS, Honeywell, utility APIs, manual upload	Energy costs per room, HVAC efficiency, seasonal patterns	**V2**
E8	**Procurement / Invoices**	Folio, Fintech, or manual PDF/CSV invoice upload with OCR	Vendor spending, contract terms, item-level costs, price trends	**V1 — Powers Cost Cutter recommendations**
E9	**Revenue Management**	RoomPriceGenie, Lighthouse, IDeaS, Duetto	Rate recommendations, competitor pricing, demand forecasts	**V2 — Enriches forecasting models**

3. Technical Architecture

3.1 Stack

Layer	Technology	Notes
Frontend	Next.js + React + Tailwind	Deploy on Vercel. SSR for fast loads. Parth owns UI.
Backend	Node.js (Fastify) or Python (FastAPI)	Svar decides. Python better for data/ML pipelines.
Database	PostgreSQL (Supabase) + Redis cache	Multi-tenant from Day 1. Supabase free tier for MVP.
AI / LLM	Claude API or OpenAI GPT-4o	Structured prompts with financial context injection.
Auth	Supabase Auth or Clerk	Magic links for easy hotel onboarding.
Hosting	Vercel (frontend) + Railway (backend)	Free tiers for MVP. Scale as needed.
Integrations	REST APIs + Plaid (banking) + OCR (invoices)	Abstraction layer: each connector is a plugin.
Dev Tools	GitHub org, Claude worktree, Linear, Vercel previews	Claude worktree for AI-assisted coding.

3.2 Architecture Principles

- Integration Abstraction Layer — every data source connects through a standardized adapter. Adding a new PMS = write one adapter file, not refactor the app.
- Event-Driven Pipeline — new data arrives → trigger analysis → check for anomalies → update dashboard → send alerts.
- Prompt Engineering Layer — all AI features use structured prompt templates with hotel context injected. Easy to iterate prompts without touching business logic.
- Multi-Tenant from Day 1 — each hotel's data is fully isolated in the database schema.
- API-First — backend is a REST API the frontend consumes. Mobile app and partner integrations come free later.

4. Two-Week Sprint Plan

Day-by-day tasks. Every task maps to the 2-week deadline of 3–5 clients + YC submission.

Week 1: Build Foundation (Days 1–7)

Svar — Engineering

- **Day 1–2:** Set up monorepo, backend framework, database, auth. Fork base repo and strip irrelevant code. Set up Claude worktree.
- **Day 3–4:** Build frontend shell: login, dashboard skeleton, settings. Functional, not pretty.
- **Day 4–6:** First PMS integration (based on hotel friend's system). Pull reservation + revenue data.
- **Day 6–7:** Build AI Daily Summary (feature A1) and Spend Analysis (feature B1). Connect financial data to LLM.
- **Day 7:** Deploy to staging. Set up CI/CD pipeline.

Arjun + Aarush — Business & Brand

- **Day 1–5:** Arjun: Research competitors, build hotel contact spreadsheet (50+ contacts), start identifying potential vendor partners for Cost Cutter marketplace.
- **Day 1–4:** Aarush: Choose company name, design logo, set up professional email, LinkedIn page, landing page with waitlist.

- **Day 3–7:** Aarush: Begin drafting YC application prompts. Write YC video script.
- **Day 5–7:** Both: Start warm outreach to hotel contacts. Book 5+ intro calls for Week 2.

All Team — Day 1 Logistics

- Buy domain (check .com price, fallback to GitHub Student .xyz)
- Create GitHub org, shared Google Drive, team Discord/Slack, Linear board
- Svar shares hotel friend feedback → team adjusts feature priorities (Day 2)
- Decide business model and pricing (Day 3)

Week 2: Ship & Sell (Days 8–14)

Svar + Parth — Engineering

- **Day 8–10:** Parth joins: overhaul frontend UI/UX. Focus on dashboard and onboarding flow. Make it demo-ready.
- **Day 8–10:** Svar: Build anomaly alerts (features C1, C2). Add email notification system.
- **Day 10–11:** Svar: Add accounting integration (QuickBooks or Xero) for full P&L data.
- **Day 11–12:** Parth: Build onboarding wizard — hotel connects PMS, sees first insights in <10 minutes.
- **Day 13–14:** Both: Bug fixes, polish, stability. Platform must work for live client demos.
- **Day 14:** Svar: Record product demo video for YC application.

Arjun + Aarush — Sales & YC

- **Day 8–12:** Run onboarding calls. Walk hotels through connecting systems. Target: 3–5 onboarded.
- **Day 10–14:** Collect testimonials and specific savings numbers from every pilot hotel.
- **Day 10–13:** Aarush: Finalize all YC application prompts. Film and edit 60-sec video.
- **Day 13:** Get 2–3 external reviews of YC application (mentors, YC alums).
- **Day 14:** Submit YC application.

5. Partner Sourcing Plan (For Cost Cutter)

Arjun should start building the partner pipeline in Week 1 alongside the hotel contact list. We don't need signed partners for MVP, but we need 3–5 for V1.

Partner Outreach Script

"Hi [Name], we're building an AI platform used by independent hotels that identifies where they're overspending on [your category]. When our AI flags an overspend, we recommend better alternatives. We'd like to feature [your company] as a recommended vendor. You'd get warm, qualified leads from hotel operators who are already looking to switch. No upfront cost — we work on a referral fee or rev share. Interested in a quick call?"

Priority Partners to Source

- Linen & laundry services (local and national)
- Hotel toiletry and amenity suppliers
- Cleaning product distributors
- F&B distributors (especially those competing with Sysco/US Foods)
- Credit card processing companies (Stax, Stripe, Square)

- Energy management / utility brokers
- Insurance brokers specializing in hospitality
- Hotel SaaS tools (PMS alternatives, CRM, guest messaging)

6. Business Model Decision (Decide by Day 3)

With the partner marketplace, we now have a dual-revenue model that's significantly stronger. Here's how the math works:

Revenue Source	Per Hotel / Year	At 100 Hotels
SaaS Subscription (avg $499/mo)	$5,988	$598,800
Partner Referral Revenue (conservative)	$4,000–$8,000	$400,000–$800,000
TOTAL per hotel	**$10,000–$14,000**	**$1M–$1.4M**

This dual model is extremely compelling for YC. You're not just a SaaS tool — you're a marketplace that generates more revenue per customer the longer they use the product.

Pilot Pricing Recommendation

- First 3–5 hotels: $99/month pilot rate for 3 months. In exchange: feedback, testimonial, case study rights.
- After pilot: graduate to $299/month (Starter) or $499/month (if they use Cost Cutter recommendations).
- Partner revenue kicks in once we have 3–5 partners signed, even at pilot scale.
- YC pitch: "We're already generating $X/month in SaaS revenue AND $Y/month in partner referral fees from just 5 hotels."

7. Setup & Logistics Checklist

Task	Owner	Day	Status	Notes
Buy domain (.com or GitHub Student .xyz)	Svar	1	TODO	
Activate GitHub Student Dev Pack	Arjun / Aarush	1	TODO	Free .xyz domain
Create GitHub org + private repo	Svar	1	TODO	
Set up pro email (Google Workspace or Zoho free)	Aarush	2	TODO	team@domain
Create team Discord/Slack	Aarush	1	TODO	
Set up Linear (task tracking)	Svar	1	TODO	Free tier
Shared Google Drive folder	Arjun	1	TODO	
Brand: name, logo, colors, guidelines	Aarush	3	TODO	Canva/Figma
LinkedIn company page	Aarush	3	TODO	
Landing page with waitlist	Aarush	4	TODO	Framer or Next.js
Competitor research spreadsheet	Arjun	3	TODO	
Hotel contacts spreadsheet (50+)	Arjun + Aarush	5	TODO	

Partner vendor prospect list (20+)	Arjun	7	**TODO**	For Cost Cutter
Draft all YC application prompts	Aarush + all	10	**TODO**	
Film + edit YC video (60 sec)	Aarush	12	**TODO**	
Record product demo video	Svar	13	**TODO**	
5+ hotel intro calls booked	Arjun + Aarush	7	**TODO**	
3–5 hotels onboarded + paying	All	14	**TODO**	
SUBMIT YC APPLICATION	All	14	**TODO**	

8. Open Decisions (Resolve This Week)

#	Decision	Options / Context	Who / When
1	**Company name**	Needs to work as a domain. Brainstorm + vote.	All team — Day 1
2	**Business model / pricing**	SaaS + partner affiliate (recommended). See Section 6.	All team — Day 3
3	**First PMS integration**	Mews vs. Cloudbeds vs. hotel friend's system. Build for their stack.	Svar — Day 2 (after feedback)
4	**Backend language**	Node.js (Fastify) vs. Python (FastAPI). Python better for data/ML.	Svar + Parth — Day 2
5	**LLM provider**	Claude API vs. OpenAI vs. both. Test quality on hotel data.	Svar — Day 3
6	**Domain: .com or free .xyz**	Check pricing. If .com is >$50, use GitHub Student .xyz for now.	Svar — Day 1
7	**Pilot pricing for first clients**	$99/mo pilot (recommended) vs. free vs. full price. Affects YC traction.	All team — Day 3
8	**Hotel friend feedback → priorities**	Svar shares notes, team adjusts feature priorities accordingly.	Svar — Day 2

14 DAYS. 3–5 CLIENTS. 1 YC APPLICATION. BUILD THE MACHINE.